

To take a snapshot of your system, start the command prompt in admin mode and run the following command line:

```
recimg -CreateImage C:\Path\To\Image\Folder
```

This will create a file called CustomRefresh.wim in the supplied folder and register that image file as a custom refresh image. You can create multiple such refresh images and switch between them using the "recimg -SetCurrent" command.

Disable UAC Completely

UAC, or User Account Control works differently in Windows 8 than it did before and the new way it works might catch you off guard if you are used to the old way of doing things.

But before disabling it let's see what it does. UAC runs all software as a standard user with standard privileges so that no software has more system access than it needs. Software that need to perform an operation that requires more privileges trigger a special prompt that asks the user to confirm whether that action should be allowed. If UAC is disabled, there are no prompts, and every software runs with full privileges by default.

This has changed in Windows 8, where first of all, UAC simply cannot be disabled in the same way it could be in Windows 7 and Vista. In Windows 8, decreasing the security level of UAC simply removes all prompts, but UAC continues working and all applications still run as a standard user. If a software needs administrative privileges and asks for them, Windows silently gives those applications more privileges. However there are still software that need admin permissions, but aren't designed to work with UAC, and simply fail to run as they don't have enough permissions. For these software the way to give admin permissions is to right click on the shortcut / exe and select "Run as administrator". This is actually good for security, but for some power users it can be annoying.

It is possible to turn off UAC completely in Windows 8 but it comes at a huge cost, it will completely disable all Windows Store / Modern UI apps.

First let's reduce the UAC setting to their lowest.

- ▶ Press [Win]+[W] to search for settings in the start screen, type "uac" and press enter.
- ▶ In the window that opens up, move the slider all the way to the bottom.
- ▶ Click OK to save the settings.

To disable UAC completely follow the steps below: